

KYLE GAARDER

Customer Success Leader | Retention & Relationships | Growth

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SUMMARY

Customer success leader with 82% retention across 140+ client relationships. I build my career on keeping customers - through relationship-driven service, proactive engagement, and systematic retention programs. My background spans housing, community, and service businesses where long-term relationships drive growth.

For Closinglock: I keep customers — 82% retention across 140+ client relationships through proactive engagement, systematic onboarding, and relationship-driven service.

Founder, Product & Operations

Revillage Coliving

📅 08/2022 - 07/2024 📍 Austin, TX

- Launched an 8-bedroom coliving property in 2 weeks, reaching 100% occupancy before lease start
- Designed onboarding and retention systems sustaining 94% occupancy for 19 consecutive months
- Ran 48 community programs, 4 masterminds, and 6 initiatives driving engagement and satisfaction
- Built systematic communication and conflict-resolution frameworks for long-term relationships
- Executed A/B pricing experiments driving 48% revenue lift while maintaining high satisfaction
- Directed full-cycle operations, improving efficiency 212% YoY through client-focused optimization
- Facilitated smooth acquisition transition while maintaining positive client relationships

Co-Founder, Strategy & Operations

Van Village

📅 01/2021 - 08/2022 📍 Portland, OR

- Built demand pipeline of 3,140 subscribers through grassroots relationship outreach
- Conducted 48 customer interviews to understand satisfaction drivers and retention factors
- Explored partnerships across 5 states and personally secured an investor-backed pilot program
- Led customer relationship strategy across operations and community in startup environment

Co-Founder, Operations & Growth

Lake Barcroft Boats

📅 01/2011 - 01/2016 📍 Falls Church, VA

- Built a niche service business from zero to 140+ clients
- Achieved 82% customer retention through relationship-driven service
- Generated 46% year-over-year revenue growth by improving pricing, operations, and service offerings
- Personally closed 30-40 new clients per summer through direct outreach and referrals
- Managed scheduling, pricing, contractors, and customer relationships across 230+ completed service contracts

KEY ACHIEVEMENTS

-  **82% Customer Retention**
Achieved 82% customer retention through relationship-driven service across 140+ clients
-  **140+ Client Relationships**
Built and managed concurrent client relationships with proactive engagement programs
-  **94% Occupancy via Retention**
Retention-driven systems sustained 94% occupancy for 19 months in emerging market
-  **Investor Pilot Secured**
Sourced and secured an investor-backed pilot for a new community concept across 5 states
-  **Demand Pipeline Built**
Built early demand pipeline of 3,140 subscribers through concept validation and outreach

SKILLS

- Customer Success
- Retention & Churn Prevention
- Relationship Management
- Onboarding & Adoption
- Client Communication Comms
- Conflict Resolution Support
- Partnerships Market Creation

EDUCATION

- Bachelors in Science, Biology**
Virginia Tech
📅 08/2010 - 05/2014
📍 Virginia, USA
 - Minors in Psychology, International Studies, Spanish
- GPA
3.5 / 4.0